

## ESSENTIAL

# Financial Requirements Overview

What German missions look for, and how a Verpflichtungserklärung fits in

---

**VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY**

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

## Reference amounts and what German missions look for

As with other Schengen states, there isn't a single EU-wide fixed minimum - German missions assess whether your evidence shows you can support yourself for the trip without working or relying on public funds. In practice, German consular guidance has traditionally referenced a daily amount as a planning benchmark; confirm the current figure with your specific mission rather than relying on an old number.

## What matters in practice

- Funds proportionate to your stated trip length, adjusted for whether accommodation is already covered by a Verpflichtungserklärung
- Consistency with your stated income and travel plans
- If your host has provided a Verpflichtungserklärung, that covers the costs it commits to - you don't need to separately evidence what your host has already guaranteed

## Acceptable evidence

- Bank statements covering a reasonable recent period
- Pay slips or an employer letter confirming income
- Your host's Verpflichtungserklärung, for the portion of costs it covers

## Red flags

- A large, recent, unexplained deposit shortly before applying
- A gap between what your Verpflichtungserklärung claims to cover and what your own evidence shows for the remainder